THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 05

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

When a rocket leaves the ground, thousands of people stand on rooftops to watch it, and thousands more complain about what it costs. 'Why spend crores on the sky,' they ask, 'when so much is needed on the earth?' It is a fair question and deserves a fair answer.

The first answer is that space research has already come down to earth. Weather satellites warn fishermen of cyclones and give farmers an idea of when the rains will arrive. Communication satellites carry our telephone calls and television programmes, and navigation systems help ambulances find the shortest road. Many of the materials used in modern kitchens, hospitals and sports shoes were first developed because a space mission needed something light and strong.

The second answer is about the future. Our planet will one day face dangers such as a large asteroid, a shortage of resources or a change in climate. Only nations that have developed advanced technologies will be able to study such dangers and prepare for them. Every successful launch trains a generation of engineers, scientists and technicians who will work not only for space but also for medicine, communications and defence. When India's Mars orbiter reached its destination on its first attempt, the news inspired schoolchildren in the smallest towns to look up at the night sky and ask questions.

The third answer is economic. A country that can launch satellites for others earns money and respect. Today, several nations send their small satellites into orbit on Indian rockets because the cost is low and the record is good. Money spent in this manner returns, over time, to the people who first paid for it.

The second answer is less visible but more important. A country that builds rockets must train engineers, chemists and mathematicians of the highest quality. These people do not remain in space centres for ever; they move to industries, universities and start-ups, and carry their skill with them. A single successful mission can inspire a whole generation of children to look up and ask, 'How?'

Still, the critics are partly right. A nation must also build schools, hospitals and roads, and no scientist would deny it. The wise path is not to choose between earth and sky, but to see that the one supports the other. The wealth of knowledge that comes from space should return, again and again, to the people who paid for it.

(i) People complain about rocket launches because of: 1

(a) their cost **(b)** their noise **(c)** their danger **(d)** their delay

(ii) Weather satellites help farmers by: 1

(a) irrigating the fields **(b)** storing grain

(c) giving an idea of when the rains will arrive
(d) supplying seeds

(iii) Materials developed for space missions are now used in: 1

(a) kitchens, hospitals and sports shoes
(b) only roads
(c) only schools
(d) only rockets

(iv) The 'second answer' stresses the value of: 1

(a) trained people and inspiration
(b) profits
(c) weapons
(d) tourism

(v) The writer's final view is that: 1

(a) schools are unimportant
(b) earth and sky should support each other
(c) only rockets matter
(d) space research should stop

(vi) Name two services provided by satellites. 1

(vii) How do ambulances benefit from space technology? 1

(viii) What does a successful mission do to children? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'people who disagree or find fault'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'not easily seen'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

To mark National Space Day, the Space Club of the school organised an exhibition on launches. Its members collected figures from the websites of four space agencies for the last calendar year, taking care to count only launches of orbital rockets and leaving out small test flights. The agencies of the four countries are shown here as A, B, C and D, so that students may compare the data without being influenced by national pride.

The Space Club of a school displayed the following data about launches by four countries in a year.

Country	Launches	Successful
A	20	18
B	10	9
C	8	8
D	12	9

After the exhibition, the club's president remarked that a failure should not be seen as a waste. Each unsuccessful launch, she said, gives engineers valuable data on what to improve, and many of the greatest achievements in space were made possible by earlier mistakes. Visitors were asked to write their views on a board, and several of them suggested that more school students should be taken to visit a launch centre. The exhibition also included a model of a rocket made from waste material by the students of Class 8, which was so popular that it had to be shifted to the main gate.

(i) Which country had the highest number of launches? 1

(a) D **(b)** C **(c)** A **(d)** B

(ii) Which country had a 100% success record? 1

(a) D **(b)** C **(c)** A **(d)** B

(iii) How many launches failed in country D? 1

(a) 1 **(b)** 0 **(c)** 3 **(d)** 2

(iv) What is the total number of launches by the four countries? 1

(v) What is the total number of successful launches? 1

(vi) What percentage of launches by country A were successful? 1

(vii) Which country had the lowest success rate? 1

(viii) How many launches in all did not succeed? 1

(ix) What conclusion can the club draw about space missions? 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'a flight into space'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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